

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Defensive Operations | Threat Detection and Incident Response

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience in defensive security operations, incident response, and detection engineering. I specialise in advanced threat hunting, developing Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) detection content using Kusto Query Language (KQL) in Microsoft Sentinel, and conducting full-lifecycle incident response aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework and NIST SP 800-61. I have deep hands-on expertise with Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), including Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender, alongside CrowdStrike Falcon endpoint detection and response. I am experienced at escalating investigations, performing root cause analysis, and converting threat hunt findings into detection rules and tuning recommendations. I bring a track record of mentoring junior analysts and translating complex attacker techniques into actionable, measurable security improvements.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL analytics rules, workbooks, data connectors, MITRE ATT&CK coverage mapping), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Splunk/Security Processing Language (SPL)
- **Endpoint and Identity Protection:** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent/Insight/Discover (EDR), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Microsoft Defender for Identity, Microsoft 365 Defender, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Threat Hunting and Incident Response:** MITRE ATT&CK framework gap analysis, threat intelligence-led hunting, root cause analysis, containment, eradication and recovery, lessons-learned reviews, NIST SP 800-61 lifecycle
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Playbook development, automated alert triage, PowerShell scripting for security automation
- **Identity and Access Management:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Frameworks and Compliance:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+
- **Additional Tooling:** Check Point Harmony (firewall), Mimecast (email security), Tanium (endpoint management), Microsoft Intune/Mobile Device Management (MDM)/Mobile Application Management (MAM)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer | University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2025 - Present*

- Lead the Defensive Operations (DefOps) function, conducting advanced investigations escalated from the Security Operations Centre (SOC), including root cause analysis, evidence gathering, containment, and remediation across Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender XDR.
- Author and deploy detection content including KQL analytics rules, custom workbooks, and data connector configurations in Microsoft Sentinel, systematically expanding MITRE ATT&CK framework coverage and reducing detection gaps.
- Develop and execute threat hunts based on current threat intelligence, MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, and lessons learned from prior incidents, converting findings directly into new detection rules or tuning recommendations.

- Drive full-lifecycle incident response (IR) activities covering detection, analysis, containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident lessons learned, aligned to NIST SP 800-61.
- Manage and optimise CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover, and NG-SIEM modules) for endpoint protection and continuous threat monitoring across the enterprise environment.
- Administer Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Microsoft Defender for Identity, configuring detection policies, reviewing alerts, and coordinating cross-platform response actions via Microsoft 365 Defender.
- Develop and maintain Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks using PowerShell scripting and Microsoft Sentinel automation rules to reduce mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Mentor junior security analysts, providing technical guidance on KQL development, alert investigation methodology, and attacker Tactics, Techniques and Procedures (TTPs).
- Drive vulnerability management programmes using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, and AppCheck, prioritising remediation in alignment with the NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) and CIS Controls.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity | University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

- Performed Tier 2 and Tier 3 alert triage and security incident investigations across SIEM platforms, escalating confirmed incidents with detailed root cause analysis and evidence packages.
- Designed and tuned detection rules and KQL queries in Microsoft Sentinel to reduce false positives and improve signal fidelity across cloud, identity, and endpoint data sources.
- Managed Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID identity security, including Conditional Access policy design, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) rollout, and Privileged Identity Management (PIM) controls.
- Administered CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent for endpoint protection across a multi-thousand-user estate, investigating detections and refining prevention policies to balance security and operational continuity.
- Supported the implementation of BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to reduce the attack surface from privileged account compromise.
- Maintained and improved email security controls via Mimecast, tuning anti-phishing, anti-spoofing, and data loss prevention (DLP) policies to protect against inbound threats.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus compliance activities, providing technical evidence and supporting internal and external audit processes.
- Collaborated with infrastructure teams to monitor and respond to threats across Check Point Harmony firewall and Tanium endpoint visibility tooling.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure | HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

- Implemented and maintained security controls across a Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech cloud environment, ensuring alignment with ISO 27001 and CIS Controls frameworks.
- Administered endpoint security and identity management using Microsoft Intune (Mobile Device Management/Mobile Application Management), Azure Active Directory, and Microsoft 365 security features.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Nessus, tracking findings through to remediation and reporting risk posture to stakeholders.
- Supported IT quality and compliance programmes, contributing technical documentation and evidence to internal audit cycles.
- Delivered scripted automation using PowerShell to streamline routine security and infrastructure management tasks.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Microsoft Defender for Identity across an estate of over 8,000 users, standardising endpoint and identity threat detection and significantly reducing unmanaged device risk.
- Built a library of MITRE ATT&CK-aligned KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel that improved SOC alert fidelity by systematically reducing false positives and covering previously undetected attacker techniques.

- Led the design and rollout of CrowdStrike Falcon across a complex university environment, integrating NG-SIEM telemetry with Sentinel to provide unified visibility across endpoint, identity, and cloud.
 - Reduced mean time to respond (MTTR) through development of automated SOAR playbooks, enabling consistent, repeatable containment actions without manual analyst intervention for common threat scenarios.
 - Established an ongoing threat hunting programme using MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, resulting in multiple new detections converted into permanent analytics rules in Microsoft Sentinel.
 - Supported successful Cyber Essentials Plus certification by providing technical evidence across endpoint, network, identity, and patch management controls.
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EDUCATION

- Master of Science (M.Sc.) in Environmental and Resource Engineering
 - Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.) in Chemical Engineering
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CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote/Hybrid (United Kingdom)